



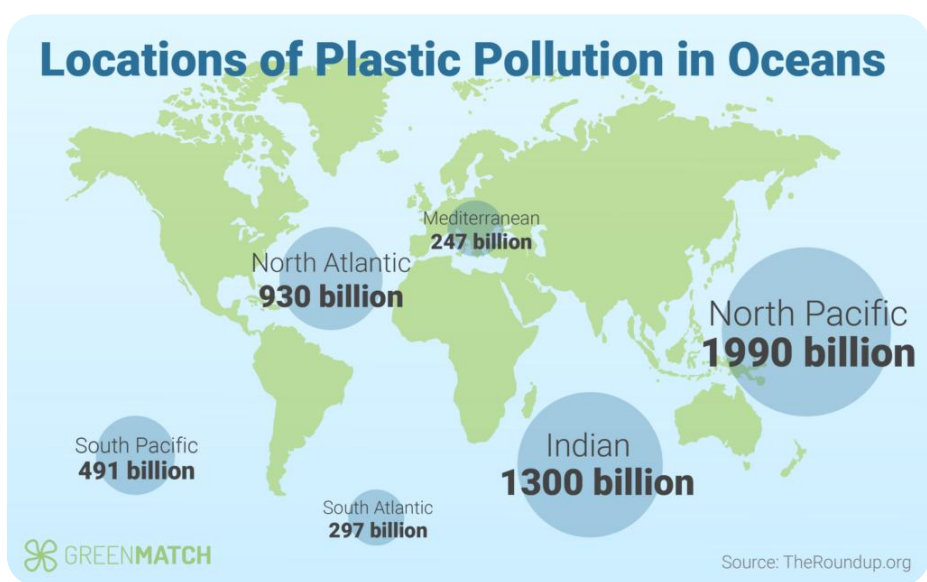
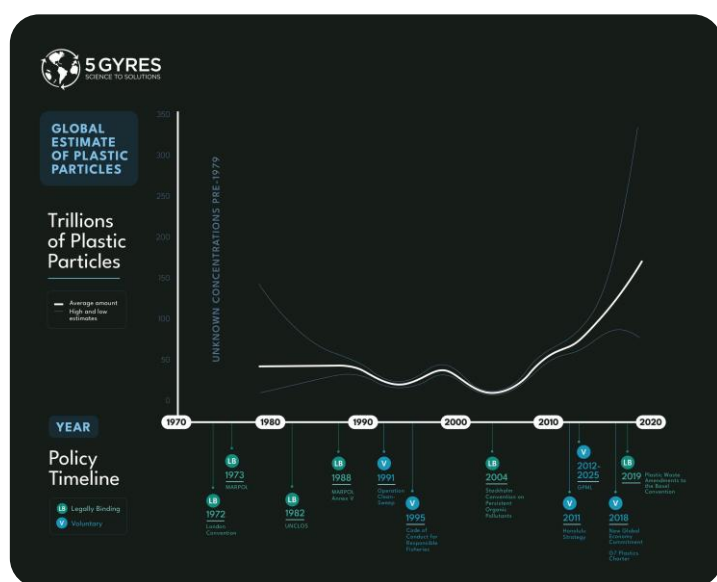
Eco-Step

Social Engagement Fund 2025

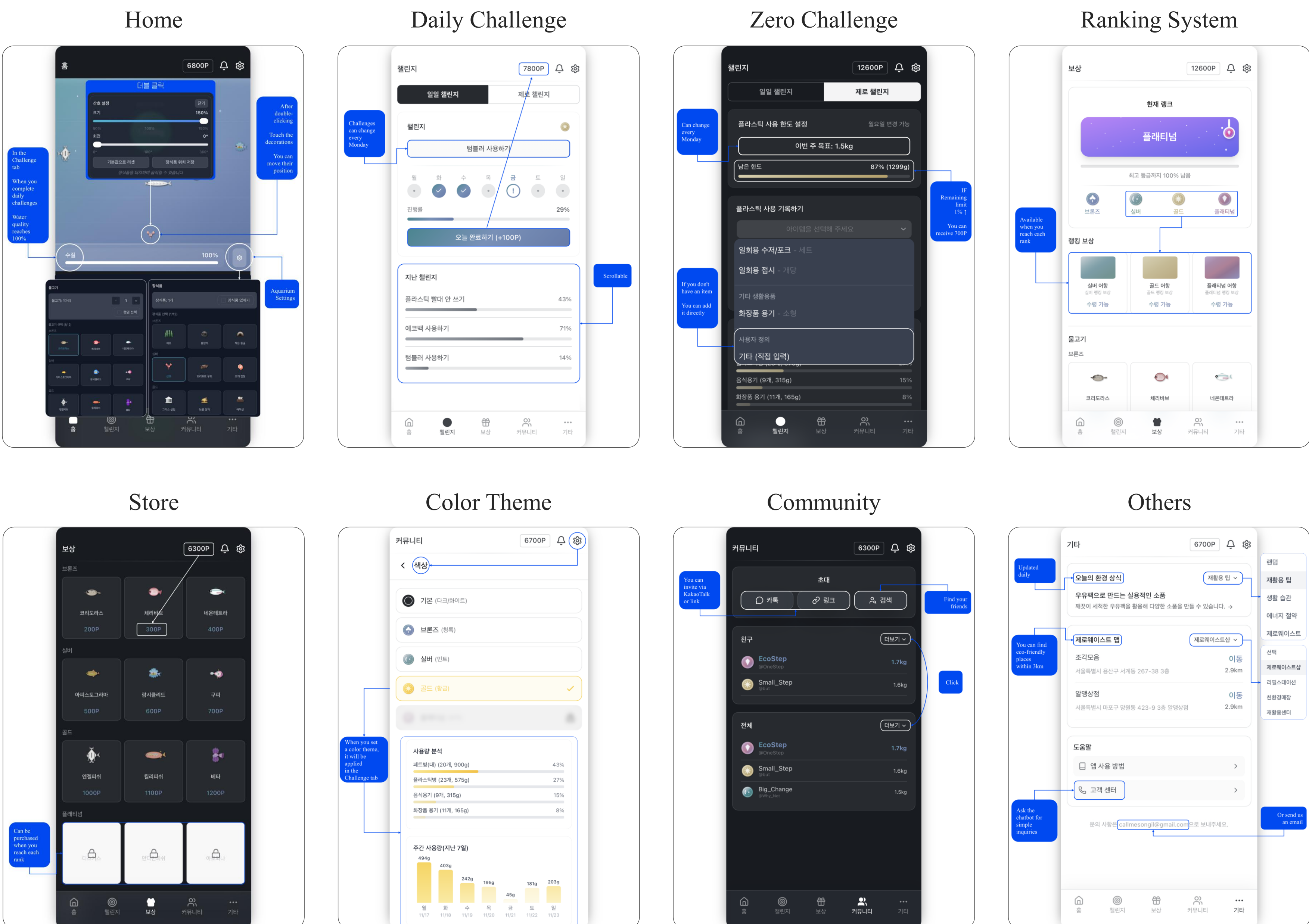
Small Steps, Big Change. Why Not?

In modern society, plastic has greatly enhanced convenience in daily life, but at the same time, it's causing serious environmental pollution problems. Microplastics, which are smaller than 5mm, are particularly difficult to identify with the naked eye. According to a study led by the 5 Gyres Institute in collaboration with UC Riverside and other international research institutions, there are approximately 171 trillion pieces of microplastics in the world's oceans, weighing about 2.3 million tons, and the rate of increase has been accelerating since 2005.

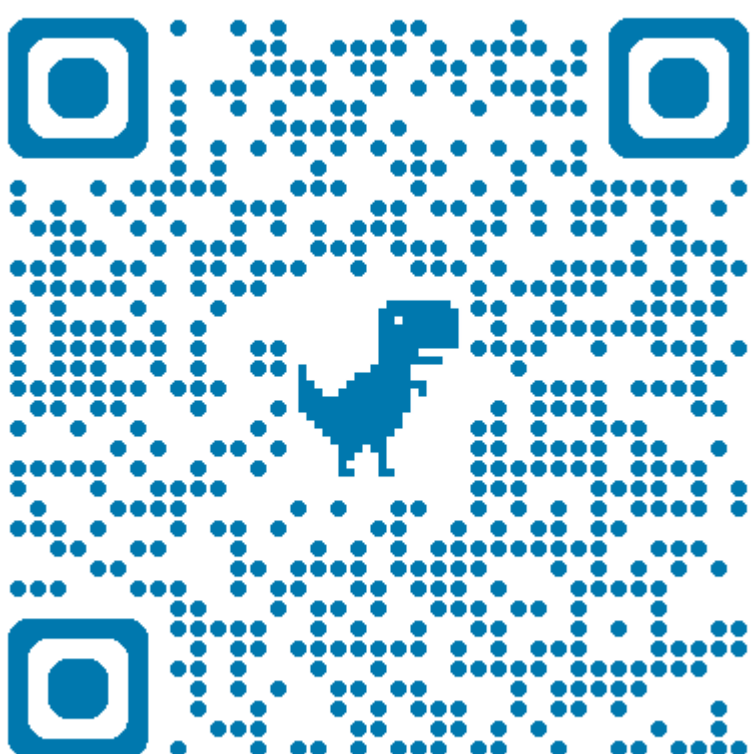
While many individuals currently have an abstract awareness of the microplastic problem, they fail to translate this into actual action due to a lack of concrete methods for implementation and the absence of visible feedback on how their individual actions affect the environment. We believe this attitude-behavior gap serves as a major reason why individual-level efforts to solve environmental problems remain unsystematic.



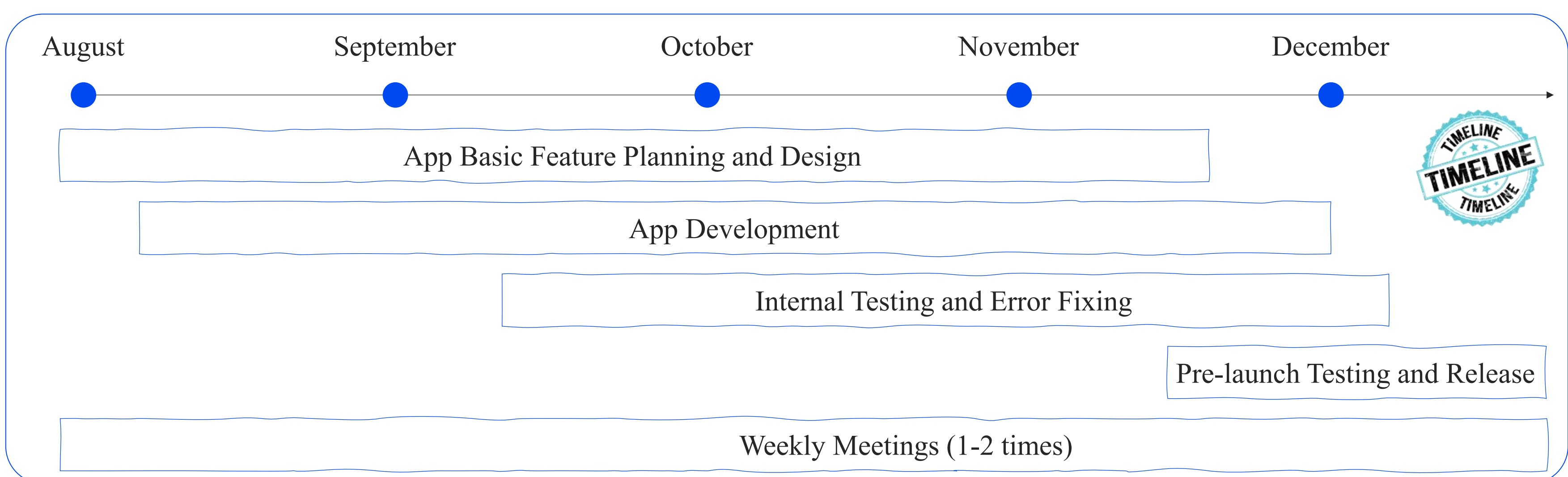
Our team aims not only to examine this plastic pollution problem from an academic perspective, but to develop practical tools that enable the younger generation to make real behavioral changes in their daily lives. To this end, we seek to implement a mobile application that systematically tracks individual plastic usage, promote behavioral change through gamification and personalization features, and visualize reduction achievements to raise environmental awareness and encourage the adoption of eco-friendly habits.



IOS



ANDROID



Future Plans

Initially, we will focus on app promotion and recruiting early adopters. Our first step is to expand our user base centered on university students interested in environmental issues, promoting through SNS and online communities. We then plan to extend our reach to the public who care about environmental problems, and in the long term, provide multilingual support including English and Chinese to make the app accessible to more people.



Additionally, we will continuously collect user feedback and use it to implement feature updates and bug fixes. By addressing the limitations of the initial version and improving user experience, we aim to develop the app into a tool that more people can utilize in their daily lives.



Lastly, we plan to explore ways to sustain ongoing app operations while also examining the possibility of expanding beyond plastic issues to address other environmental problems.



Institute for Global Engagement and Empowerment at Yonsei University

Ban Ki-moon Center for International Cooperation • Center for Global Sustainability • Leadership Center • Yonsei Institute for Global Health